

BLM-3000A Bluetooth mouse

Atrociously priced

This laptop mouse is sleek; it has a narrow profile, reminiscent of a comet. Ergonomics is spot on; however, those with thick fingers will find the buttons a little uncomfortable. Due to the narrow "comet tail," gripping the mouse is a serious challenge.

The BLM-3000A is powered by 2 AAA batteries—which will work out expensive, unless you buy rechargeables. However, an



On/Off switch is provided.

The buttons relay good tactile feedback, and the scroll wheel is nice. But at Rs 5,959, we think the BLM-3000A is atrociously priced. An RF-based keyboard-mouse combo with a laser sensor from Microsoft or Logitech costs much less.

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Bundle	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★☆☆
Overall	★★★★★

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Price: Rs 5,959

Mitashi MP-1G

A mini all-rounder!

The MP-1G is a digital music player with a difference—not only can you play your music and record from FM stations, you can also use it as a USB drive and as a voice recorder.

The bundled earphones aren't very comfortable.

The MP3, WAV, and WMA formats are supported. Voice recording is in WAV. As a USB drive, 1 GB should be good enough. An extraordinary feature is the bundled car cassette adapter that allows you to play songs from the device on any cassette player!



The player provides very good audio quality, both in terms of playback and recording. The inbuilt microphone is very sensitive; the only cause for concern is battery life—an AAA battery lasts only three hours.

Specifications

1 GB; MP3, WMA, WAV supported; voice recorder, car cassette adapter, USB 2.0

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

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Price: Rs 4,390

Corel Paint Shop Pro Photo XI

High on features, low on price



lets you preview photos and videos in full-screen mode, it also lets you apply quick fixes and edits. The Image Information panel gives you quick access to image info.

By appending the moniker "Photo", Corel has signalled it will now focus more on digital photography rather than image creation, its traditional forte. Photo XI consists of a complete set of editing tools for speedily creating professional-looking photos.

Paint Shop Pro Photo XI retains all the features of its predecessors. The "Learning Center" shows you how to get things done in an easy manner. The "Quick Review" feature not only

You have the option to work with both vector as well as raster graphics. Photographers will be delighted to know that now you can open RAW images from virtually any digital camera. Some effects are meant specifically for digital photos: the Digital Camera Noise Removal feature deserves special mention because it does an amazing job at removing the tiny specks of unnatural colour or noise, and can save days of hard work for designers. Using

the Skin Smoothing feature, you can even out the skin tone of people in a photo. Similarly, there is the Time Machine, which lets you see what your photos would look if they had been taken some years ago. There is the Depth of Field effect, which allows you to draw attention to a specific area of an image. One Step Photo Fix automatically adjusts the colour balance, contrast, clarity, and saturation to optimal levels.

One of the great features in this version is an image management tool called the Organizer: You can assign ratings, captions and descriptive tags—for easier and faster image searching—to images, and arrange them in thematic groups without physically moving them from the folder they are stored in.

Snapfire Plus SE is a nifty little digital camera software that comes

bundled. It simplifies image download from digital imaging devices in addition to organising images, executing quick fixes such as red eye, cropping and applying small photo effects, as also some image editing. It has inbuilt project templates for print layouts such as Calendar, Greeting Card, and Collage.

Corel Paint Shop Pro Photo XI comes close to some of the bigger and obscenely expensive photo editing applications, while still managing to be commendably affordable. It's definitely a good value-for-money proposition.

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★★
Value for money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Contact: Corel Corp.
Web site: www.corel.com
Price: \$129 (Rs 6,000)